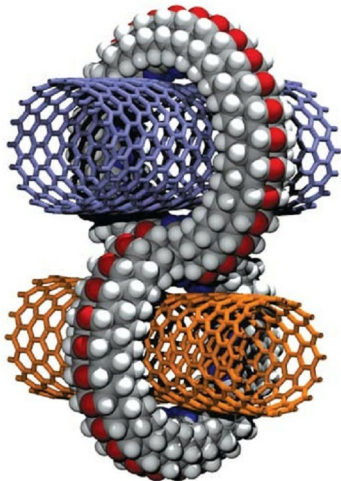


PREDICTING THE FUTURE OF ELECTRONICS

With advancements in technology, the future of electronic products and services is expected to be bright. In the next 3-4 decades, we may see several innovations that are hard to imagine at present



Studies regarding properties of nanotubes and graphene aim at developing a technology that will make devices more compact, fast and energy efficient

■ DR S.S. VERMA

Electronic gadgets have become an inseparable part of our day to day life—today, it's hard to imagine life without cellphones, computers and Internet. Developments in the electronics technology have, in a short span, gone up by leaps

and bonds.

Social scientists sometimes measure the quality of life in terms of the amount of time we spend to earn our bread—the lesser the time, the better the quality of life. As it is evident that most of our creature comforts are due to improved electronic products and services, perhaps the time we spend

using them would be a more appropriate criterion to ascertain the quality of life.

Through this article, we will try to catch the glimpses of various developments taking place in electronics field and know about future products and services that we can expect in the next 30-40 years from now.

Future of electronics

A bright future of electronic products and services is unfolding before us. In the next three to four decades, we will see a number of products that are hard to imagine today. Some of the technological advancements expected in the electronics field can be summarised as under:

1. Future cellphones may have all the mobile devices combined into one. They may be transparent, flexible, self-cleaning and shape changing.
2. Most of the electronic products will go wireless, with increased use of touch interface and green technology.
3. Emergence of affordable high-end digital cameras.
4. Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) is expected to play a significant role in improving customer services at local retail stores. Instead of a plastic band bearing a unique personal ID number, RFID chips could be incorporated into products for identification and tracking. Similarly, it could be inserted into a person to identify him/her at the time of birth.
5. Electronic ink, flexible displays and wireless connections will change the face of electronic media and electronic printing.